

Chapter 174-1

Two spring rains had fallen, and the weather was gradually warming up.

Yu Wan had already given birth. It was a baby boy, named Liang Jia.

Liang Shi had visited her a few times, though she couldn't stay too long each time.

Yu Wan always had a confinement nanny¹ and her mother by her side. Liang Xinzhou had to work during the day, and also had to handle Yu Wan's share of work. He was so busy he was like a spinning top, and had lost quite a bit of weight.

Qiu Zimin, however, rarely went to the hospital. She only bought some nutritional supplements for Yu Wan.

One time when Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu went to visit, they overheard Yu Wan's mother complaining, "She used to be a decent person. How has she become more unreasonable with age? Even if you and Xinzhou have moved out, the grandson she just gave birth to is still part of their family, isn't he? It's one thing that she's not coming to help with your postpartum recovery, but she barely even visits. Really... I think her brain has gone bad."

"Mom..." Yu Wan patted her mother's hand, signaling her to stop talking.

Yu Wan's mother was still angry, but out of consideration for her daughter's dignity and mood, she didn't continue.

Right after giving birth, one lacks sleep the most, and the body hasn't recovered yet. When Liang Shi visited, she would occasionally help watch the baby. This little one was very well-behaved—whenever Liang Shi held him, he would be amused into giggles, and would fall asleep shortly after.

This gave Yu Wan a chance to rest.

Once Yu Wan fell asleep, Liang Shi felt it wasn't appropriate to stay any longer, so she got up to leave.

Life continued on. Xu Qingzhu had strong reactions during the early stages of pregnancy. Especially when Liang Shi had just returned to her side, she would often wake up in the middle of the night to dry heave, and had to eat something sour to suppress it.

Once she passed the three-month mark, things were fine.

Moreover, because Xu Qingzhu was thin, her belly showed relatively slowly.

But it was true that she could eat more than before.

Perhaps because she was carrying twins, she now had to eat five meals a day. She would occasionally joke that she was like a Taotie.²

Liang Shi would smile and go along with her words: "It's clearly the two in your belly who are like Taotie."

Xu Qingzhu rubbed her belly. "Did you hear that? Your mom says you two are like Taotie."

Liang Shi: "...You're even tattling on me?"

"Of course." Xu Qingzhu smiled lightly. "Otherwise, what if they don't like me in the future?"

Liang Shi: "?"

"You mean it's okay for them not to like me?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu pursed her lips: "It's best if they don't like you more than they like me."

Liang Shi: "....."

At that moment, Liang Shi was sitting across from her, propping her chin with her hand as she looked at her. Outside the restaurant's huge floor-to-ceiling windows, people came and went.

"You just think everyone has to like you, don't you?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded, then shook her head: "Yes and no."

After a slight pause, she added: "It's enough as long as you like me."

"What about them?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment: "I want to be the person who loves you the most, so they can't like you more than I do."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi gently flicked her nose. "You, honestly."

Xu Qingzhu smiled tenderly.

She sat with her back to the light, sunlight falling on her, light and shadow dancing on her cheeks—serene and beautiful.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu didn't seem to have much difficulty accepting the arrival of these two children.

Even though these two children were unexpected.

Both of them had remarkably good acceptance. Perhaps it was because they loved each other so much that they naturally accepted the fruits of their love.

Liang Shi had never thought she would have her own children in this lifetime. Based on the scientific development where she came from, she probably wouldn't have been able to wait for it in her entire life.

But now it had happened so easily.

Unexpected, yet delightful.

After Xu Qingzhu became pregnant, she continued to be busy with work. It's just that as the months progressed, the time she could spend sitting and working each day became limited. Fortunately, she had started preparing during the early stages of pregnancy, so the company wasn't in chaos now.

Most importantly, Lu Jiayi was there to help.

Although Lu Jiayi didn't directly interfere with Minghui's affairs, she was fully responsible for the parts where the two of them collaborated, and Xu Qingzhu completely trusted her abilities.

Worth mentioning was that Lu Jiayi's wedding date was quickly set—in early summer, the first half of July.

When Lu Jiayi handed the invitation to Liang Shi, Liang Shi was quite surprised.

After thinking about it, she could understand.

Lu Jiayi had originally come to Haizhou to find a marriage alliance partner. In the end, she didn't find a marriage partner but found an excellent business partner instead, which was already enough for her.

At this point, if she wanted to consolidate her position in the Lu family and obtain the Lu family's inheritance rights among all the covetous candidates, finding a marriage alliance partner for herself would be ideal.

Apart from losing the freedom to marry for love, there were no other losses.

Obviously, Lu Jiayi was someone who didn't care about the freedom of marriage. She was very goal-oriented and not greedy—once she decided on career, she could sacrifice love.

Liang Shi also admired this kind of determined person.

Her fiancée Fu You was indeed very charming. To thank her for helping find the mastermind behind the hot search incident, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu treated Lu Jiayi and Fu You to a meal of Huaiyang cuisine.³

That day, Fu You wore a green hoodie, white jeans, and had wavy blue-green hair. She didn't look at all like an IT top student.

Completely different style from Lu Jiayi's white shirt and black dress pants.

Fu You had a great figure—literally a great figure.

No flaws from any angle. Her individual features were actually quite ordinary when separated, but combined together, they had a uniquely charming beauty.

The moment she saw Liang Shi, she smiled and teased: "Much prettier than in the shows."

Liang Shi smiled: "You flatter me."

"Have a seat." Fu You directly took charge as if she were the host. "I've been starving all day. Can I order whatever I want?"

"Yes," Liang Shi said. "Order whatever you want to eat."

She wasn't shy either. After ordering what she wanted, she handed the menu to Xu Qingzhu. "Little sister, your turn."

Xu Qingzhu added a few more dishes.

It actually wasn't a gathering of very familiar people, but Fu You had the ability to make everyone comfortable within just a few sentences. When chatting with Liang Shi, she specifically asked about areas Liang Shi was familiar with, such as acting, variety shows, and even asked about screenwriting.

Liang Shi answered everything, while Xu Qingzhu kept sneaking glances at Fu You.

Liang Shi pinched her under the table, and Xu Qingzhu gave her a sidelong glance.

Later during the meal, Xu Qingzhu quietly asked Liang Shi: "I wasn't lying to you, was I? She's very charming."

Liang Shi: "....."

She did admire Fu You, but after seeing how much Xu Qingzhu admired her, she became a little less admiring.

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1. "月嫂" (yuè sǎo) - A confinement nanny or postpartum care specialist. In Chinese culture, the postpartum period (called "坐月子" or "sitting the month") is traditionally a time when new mothers rest and recover for about a month, with strict guidelines about diet, activity, and care. Confinement nannies are professionals hired to help care for both the mother and newborn during this period. ↵
 2. Taotie (饕餮) - A mythical creature from ancient Chinese mythology known for its insatiable appetite and gluttony. It's often depicted on ancient bronze vessels and is one of the "Four Fiends" in Chinese mythology. The term is commonly used to describe someone with a voracious appetite. ↵
 3. Huaiyang cuisine (淮揚菜) - One of the four major traditional Chinese cuisines, originating from the Huai'an and Yangzhou regions of Jiangsu province. It's known for its delicate flavors, emphasis on freshness, and refined cooking techniques. ↵